Daily Fresh

Install and Setup Guide

Version 1.0.3 - Windows 10 / 11

What is Daily Fresh?

A Windows desktop app for recording daily money in (credit) and money out (debit). Every entry is saved in an ordinary Excel file, so your records stay readable even without the app. A small team can share work by exporting and importing CSV files, and see everything together on the Dashboard.

In this guide

- Part 1 - Installing the app on a PC
- Part 2 - First-time setup: data folder, account and login
- Part 3 - Configuring ledgers and Transactions (Modify Fields)
- Part 4 - Daily workflow: record, review, summarise
- Part 5 - Sharing work between users, where data is kept, and troubleshooting

> **About the screenshots**
> The screens in this guide were captured from the app using sample names and amounts, not real records. Your own screens will show your data.

Developed by Tenwin James

Part 1 - Installing

What you need

- A Windows 10 or Windows 11 PC (64-bit). Python is not needed.
- The setup file, named ExpenseLedger-Setup-<version>.exe, from the developer.
- About 150 MB of free disk space. No internet connection is needed to install or use the app.

Step by step

1. Copy the setup file to the PC (download, USB stick or shared folder). Only use a setup you received from the developer.
2. Double-click the setup file. If Windows shows "Windows protected your PC", see the box below, then carry on.
3. Choose who the app is for. "Install for me only" is recommended and needs no administrator approval. "Install for all users" makes the app available to every Windows user on the PC and asks for administrator approval. This question appears on a first install; later upgrades reuse your earlier choice.
4. Read the License Agreement, choose "I accept the agreement" and click Next.
5. Accept the suggested install folder, or choose another, and click Next.
6. Tick the shortcuts you want: a desktop shortcut and/or a Start Menu shortcut. Click Next.
7. (All-users installs only) An optional checkbox, "Trust the Tenwin James publisher certificate on this PC", lets Windows show the developer's name as the publisher on future setups. It is off by default. Tick it only on a PC you manage, and only if the thumbprint shown matches the one the developer gave you.
8. Click Install and wait for the progress bar to finish.
9. On the final page, leave "Launch Daily Fresh" ticked and click Finish. The app opens.

> **If Windows blocks the setup (SmartScreen)**
> Unsigned or newly signed setup files can show "Windows protected your PC". Choose one of these:
> 1. Click More info, then Run anyway.
> 2. Or, before running it, put Unblock-Setup.bat and Unblock-Setup.ps1 (supplied with the setup) in the same folder and double-click the .bat. It removes the "downloaded from the internet" mark from that one file. It needs no administrator rights and changes no Windows setting.
> Files copied through a FAT32 or exFAT USB stick usually lose that mark, so they often run without a warning.

Installing on more than one PC

- Run the setup on each PC. Copying only ExpenseLedger.exe does not work, because the app needs the files beside it.
- Your data does not travel with the setup. Each PC keeps its own login and its own ledger folder. Entries move between PCs only through Export CSV and Import CSV (Part 5).

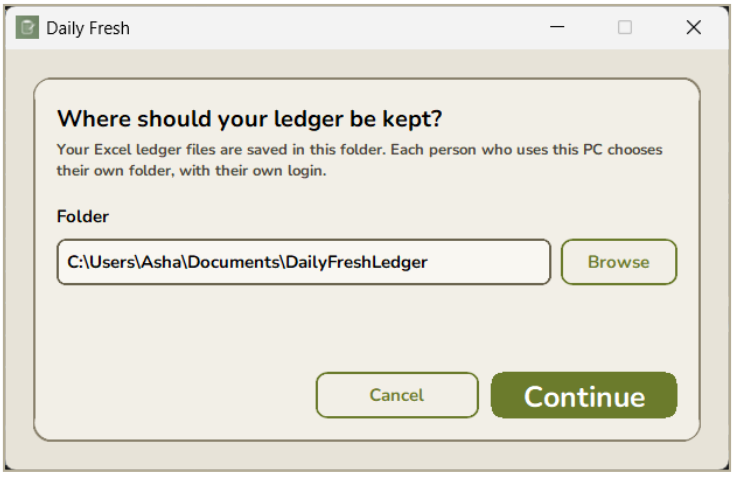
Upgrading and uninstalling

- Upgrade: run the newer setup over the old install. It closes the running app, replaces the program and keeps all your data. An older install made with the .msi installer is removed first, after asking you.
- Uninstall: Settings > Apps > Installed apps > Daily Fresh. Your entries and Transactions lists are kept. Your login is removed, so after a reinstall the app asks you to create a new account.

Part 2 - First-time setup

1. Choose the folder for your Excel files

The first time the app starts it asks where to keep the daily Excel files. Pick a folder you can save in. A folder in Documents, or a folder that your backup program already covers, is a good choice.

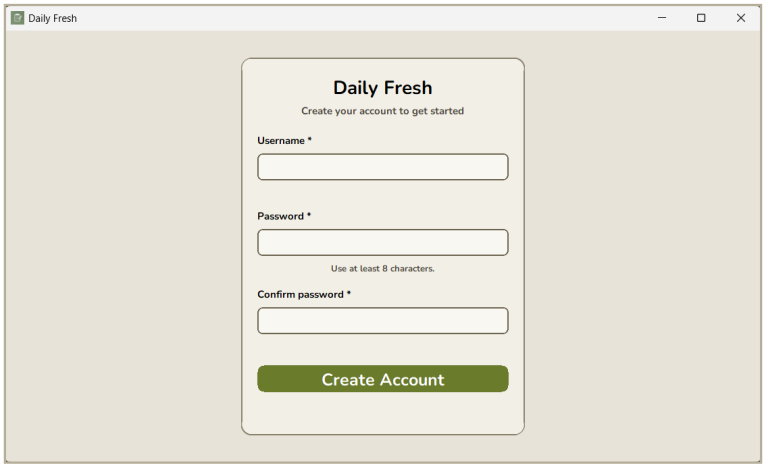


First-run window: choose the folder where the daily Excel files are kept.

> **Good to know**
> Each Windows user, and each PC, makes this choice for themselves. If you used version 1.0 before, the app keeps your existing Desktop\ExpenseLedger folder without asking.

2. Create your account

Enter a username and a password of at least 8 characters, repeat the password and click Create Account.

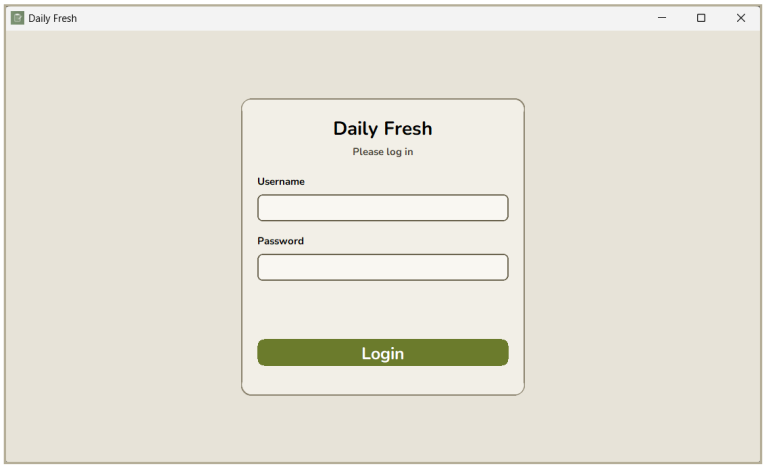


Create Account: shown once, on the first run.

> **Choose the username carefully**
> Your username becomes part of your Excel file names (for example 20-Oct-2026_asha.xlsx). Use something short and recognisable, such as your first name. When several people share work, every person needs a different username.

3. Log in

After creating the account you are taken to the login page. Enter the username and password. Five wrong tries lock the login for 5 minutes; the lock survives closing the app.

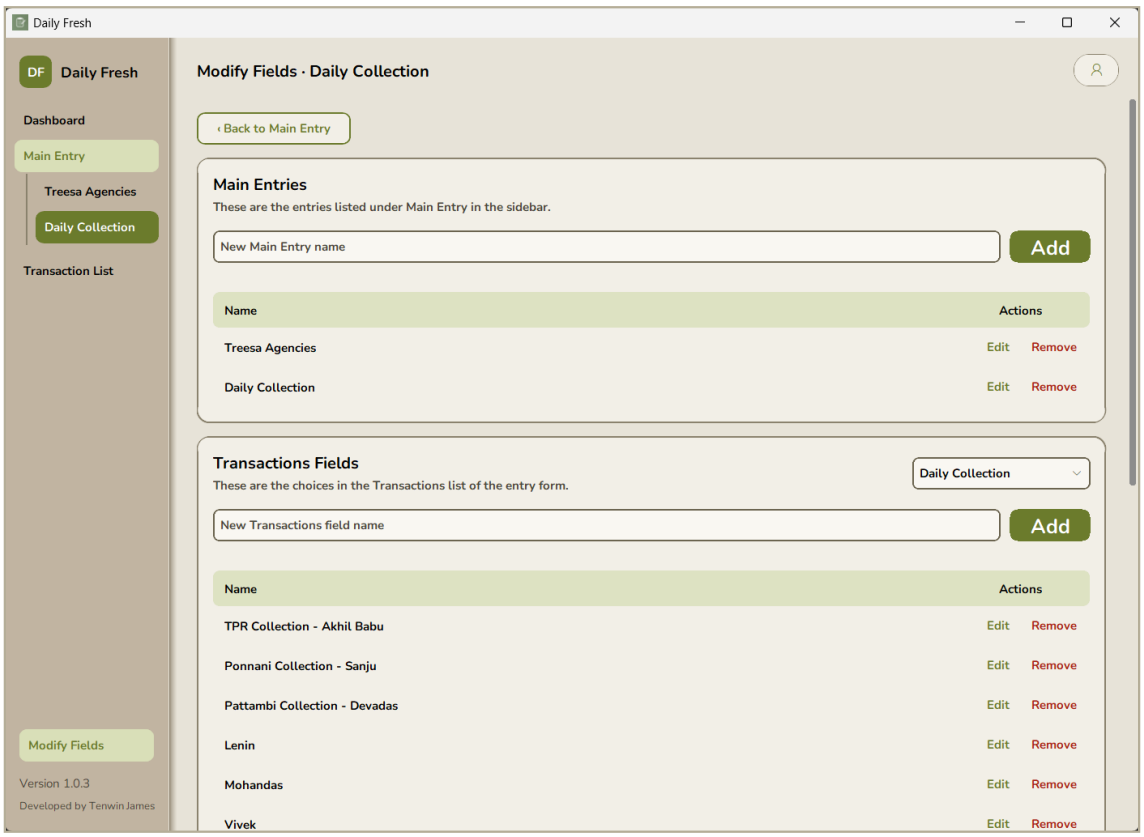


Login page.

To change the password later, click the round user button at the top right of the app and choose Change Password.

Part 3 - Configuring ledgers and Transactions

Before recording, set up the ledgers (Main Entries) and the Transactions you want to choose from. Click Modify Fields at the bottom of the sidebar.



Modify Fields: add, rename and remove Main Entries (top) and the Transactions list of each Main Entry (below).

What you can do here

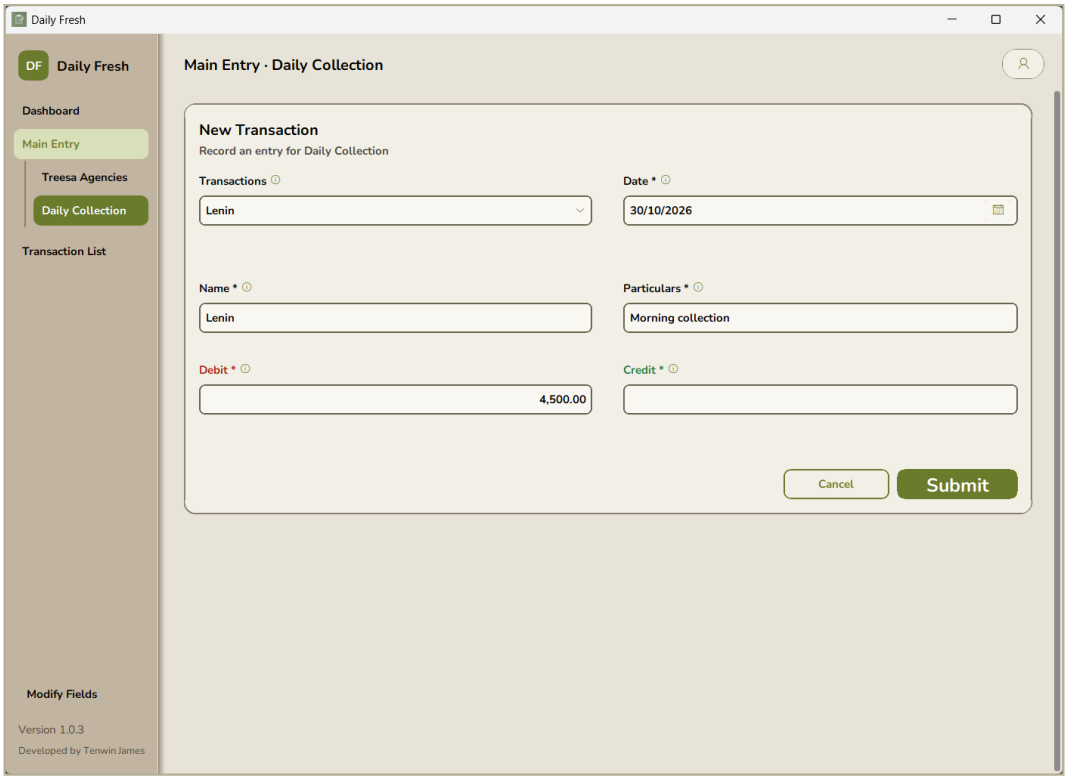
Action	How
Add a Main Entry	Type a name in "New Main Entry name" and click Add. It appears in the sidebar under Main Entry. The app starts with Treesa Agencies and Daily Collection.
Rename	Click Edit beside a name. Old entries keep working and show the new name.
Remove	Click Remove. The item is hidden from the lists but never deleted, so old entries stay intact. At least one Main Entry must remain.
Transactions list	Choose a Main Entry in the drop-down on the right, then add, rename or remove its Transactions (the choices in the entry form, such as Lenin, Mohandas or Fast Tag).

> **Tip**
> Set the lists up once with the team, before anyone records entries. Names that differ between PCs (for example "Vivek" and "Vivek K") make totals harder to compare later.

Part 4 - Daily workflow

Step 1 - Record a transaction (Main Entry)

1. Click a ledger under Main Entry in the sidebar (here, Daily Collection).
2. Choose the Transaction from the list.
3. Type the date as 30/10/2026 or 30-Oct-2026, or pick it from the calendar button.
4. Enter the Name and the Particulars (a short description).
5. Enter the Debit (money out) or the Credit (money in). Commas are fine; up to two decimals. Both cannot be zero.
6. Click Submit. The button stays grey until everything is valid, and any problem is shown under its field.

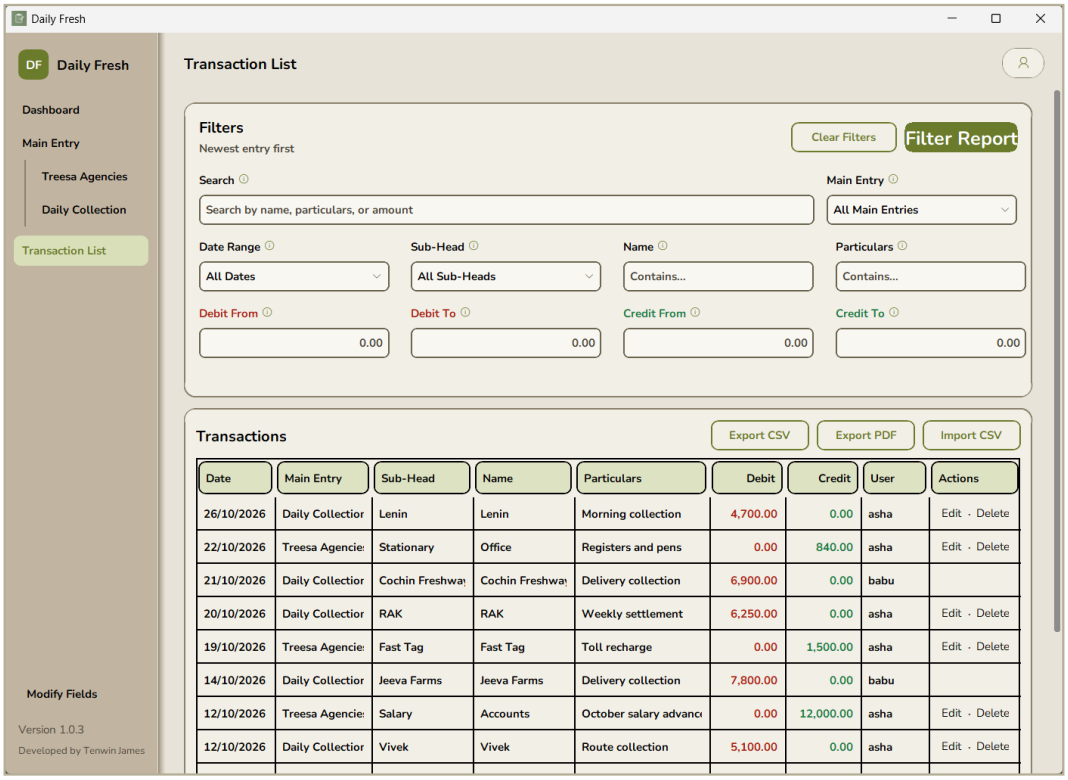


Main Entry: a completed form, ready to submit.

> **If the Excel file is open**
> If that day's Excel file is open in Excel, Windows will not let the app save. The app tells you, keeps your entry in the form and loses nothing. Close the file in Excel and click Submit again.

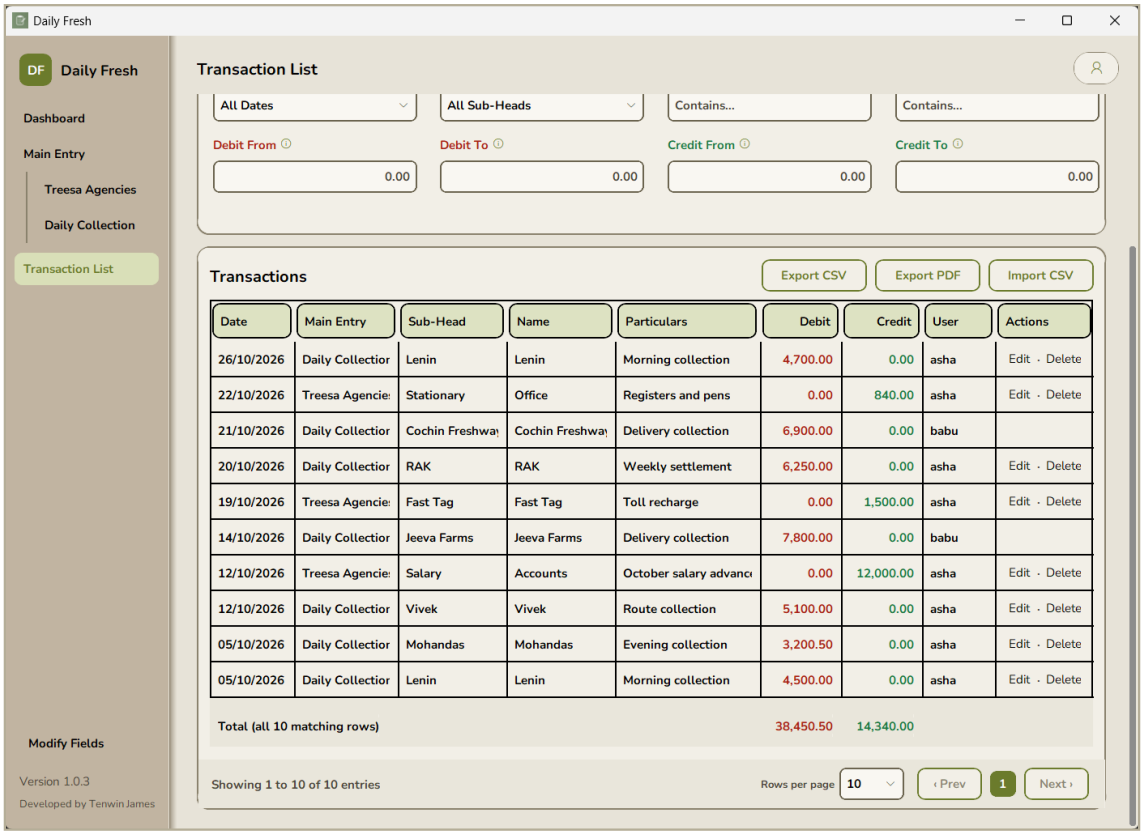
Step 2 - Review, filter and correct (Transaction List)

The Transaction List shows every entry, newest first. Use the filters and the search box at the top to narrow it down, then click Filter Report. Clear Filters shows everything again.



Transaction List - filters: search, Main Entry, date range, Sub-Head, name, particulars and amount ranges.

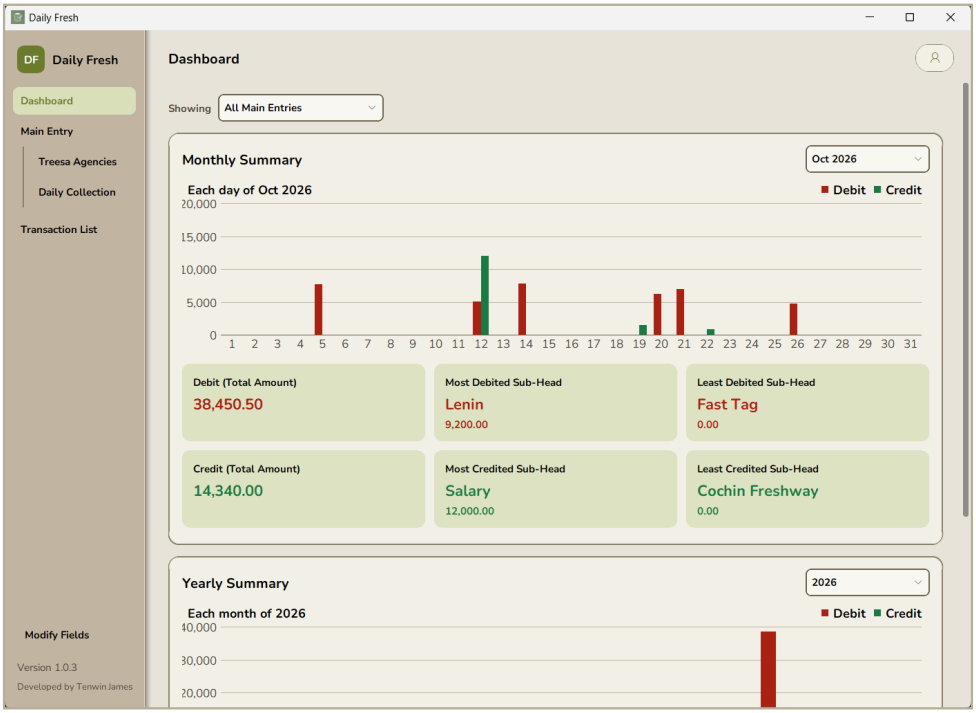
The table shows the matching rows, with totals underneath. Choose 10, 25 or 50 rows per page. Click Edit to change one of your own rows in place, or Delete (after a confirmation) to remove it.



Transaction List - table. The User column shows who entered each row. Rows from another user (babu) are read-only, so they have no Edit or Delete.

Step 3 - See the totals (Dashboard)

The Dashboard summarises one month and one year: total debit and credit, the Transactions with the most and least debit and credit, and a bar chart for each day of the month and each month of the year. Use the drop-downs to change the Main Entry or the period.



Dashboard: the Monthly Summary with a daily bar chart and the six summary cards.

Part 5 - Sharing, data and troubleshooting

Sharing work between users

Each person has their own Excel files. To let others see your work, export it; they import it. The three buttons are above the table on the Transaction List page.

Button	What it does
Export CSV	Saves the rows the filters currently show (everything if no filter is set) as a CSV file to share.
Export PDF	Saves the same rows as a printable landscape report with totals.
Import CSV	Reads a CSV exported by Daily Fresh. If any row is invalid, nothing is imported and the message names the line. Imported rows are saved in files named with their owner, shown in the User column, counted on the Dashboard and read-only. Importing the same file twice adds nothing.

> **A simple routine for a team of three**
> At the end of each week every person clicks Export CSV (with no filter), puts the file in a shared folder or on a USB stick, and the others click Import CSV. Because importing the same file twice adds nothing, it is safe to import everyone's newest file on top of an older one. Only import files from people you trust.

Where your data is

What	Where
Daily Excel files	The folder you chose on first run, in <year>\<MM-Mon>\, one file per day per user, named like 20-Oct-2026_asha.xlsx.
Login, lists, settings	%APPDATA%\ExpenseLedger (type this into the Explorer address bar to open it).
Speed-up index	%APPDATA%\ExpenseLedger\entries-index.db. It is only a cache; deleting it is safe, it is rebuilt from the Excel files.
Automatic backups	%APPDATA%\ExpenseLedger\Backups, made before the app changes saved files to a newer format.

Your Excel files are the real records. Back up the data folder the way you back up any important folder. You can open the files in Excel to read or add up figures; close them before saving new entries in the app.

Troubleshooting

Message or problem	What to do
"Windows protected your PC"	See the SmartScreen box in Part 1.
"The Excel file for ... is open"	Close that day's file in Excel and click Submit again. Your entry is still in the form.
"Too many attempts"	Wait for the time shown (5 minutes) and try again.
Forgot the password	There is no reset. Uninstall and reinstall: that removes the login only. Create a new account when asked, using the same username so your file names stay the same. Your entries are kept.
Import: "not an export from this app"	The file was not made by Export CSV, or its headings were changed. Ask for a fresh export.
Import: "Line N: ..."	Row N has an invalid date, amount or ID, or a blank field. Nothing was imported. Fix it or re-export.
The list looks out of date	Open another page and come back. If it still looks wrong, delete entries-index.db (see above) and restart.

Still stuck?
Note the exact message on screen and send it, with the file %APPDATA%\ExpenseLedger\app.log, to the developer, Tenwin James.